Lesson plan · for the teacher

Loops: repeat the pattern

Programming · Level 1 · Lesson 2

Time
40 min

Materials
Chalk for a grid; Arrow cards and number cards 1 to 4; Your phone (optional) with this lesson downloaded

Learning goals

- Spot repeated steps and turn them into a loop.
- Compare two programs by how many cards they need.
- Explain why a loop is easier to change.

Activity: Clap the loop

1. Warm-up (5 min): Clap “clap, clap, stamp” four times; pupils copy. Ask them to describe what you did in as few words as possible.
2. Teach (10 min): Write the twelve steps in full on the board, then “clap, clap, stamp: repeat 4 times”. Count the instructions in each. Ask what changes for ten times.
3. Create (10 min): Groups invent their own pattern of three or four moves and write it both ways, counting the instructions.
4. Perform (10 min): Each group performs its loop version. The class reads the full version and checks that nothing is missing.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Ask where loops appear in songs, games and school routines. Then give the exit ticket.

Noisy but worth it: a pattern pupils perform is a loop they remember. No device is needed.

Discussion

- Why is a loop easier to change than the full version?
- Which loops do pupils already know from songs and games?
- When is a loop not worth it?

Exit ticket

- Write a pattern as a loop, and say how many steps it saves.

Try it in class tomorrow
Clap a pattern (clap, clap, stamp) and ask pupils to write it four times in full, then as “repeat 4 times”. Which is quicker to write, and to change to ten times?

Worksheet · for pupils

Loops: repeat the pattern

Programming · Level 1 · Lesson 2

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **"Repeat 3 times: forward 2." How many squares does the robot move?**

○ 5 ○ 6 ○ 3

2 **Walk the robot to the flag in the opposite corner. Without repeats it needs 11 cards; with repeats you can use 6 at most.**

					★
↑					

Cut out cards (↑ forward, ↶ turn left, ↷ turn right) and lay out a program that takes the robot to the ★. Write it here:

3 **This is the robot's loop written in Python. How many times does the robot move forward?**

```
for i in range(4):
    forward()
```

○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5

4 **Match each everyday job to the loop that describes it.**

Sing the chorus three times	• • • •	Repeat until something happens
Call every name in the register	• • • •	For each pupil in the list
Stir the tea until the sugar dissolves	• • • •	Repeat 3 times

5 **A program with a loop can do exactly the same walk as a long program without one, with fewer cards.**

○ True ○ False

✎ **Which routine in your classroom is already a loop (the register, collecting books, a song)? Write it as “repeat … times”, “for each …” or “until …”.**